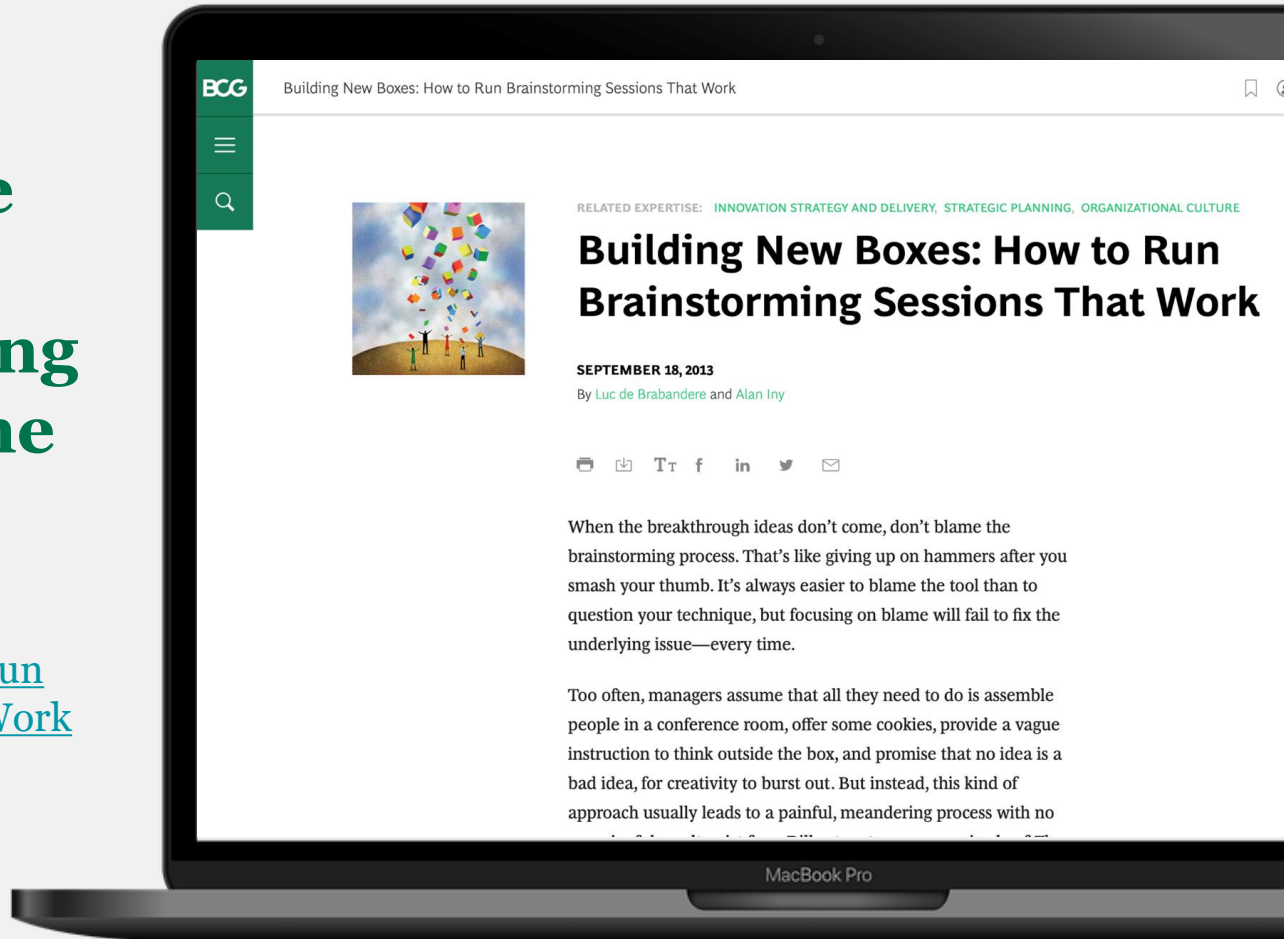


Building new boxes



We are going to discuss effective brainstorming. Start by reviewing this article on the BCG website:

[Building New Boxes: How to Run Brainstorming Sessions That Work](#)



The article offers five suggestions to achieve real, valuable insights from brainstorming

We will focus on three of these in today's task (as well as the brainstorming itself), highlighted in green

1.
**Frame the
question
effectively**

2.
**Create
creativity
conditions**

3.
**Reveal and
doubt your
boxes**

4.
**Bring new
boxes**

Brainstorm

5.
Follow up



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Building New Boxes: How to Run Brainstorming Sessions That Work

SEPTEMBER 18, 2013

By Luc de Brabandere and Alan Iny

Your task

BCG has been brought in to help ClothingCo, a luxury clothing brand, grow their top line (i.e., increase revenue) after a period of declining sales.

The client is gearing up for the winter season. Imagine that you are a strategy consultant working on the project.

You will enter your responses in the green boxes throughout the remaining slides.



Frame the question effectively

“If I were given one hour to save the planet, I would spend fifty-nine minutes defining the problem and one minute resolving it.”

– Albert Einstein

Question to be reframed

How could we sell more outerwear this winter season?

–

Revised, effective questions:

1. What does a working class look for in a winter wear?
2. How can we get our customers to talk to their friends about our products?
3. How can we make sure our winter jacket is the first thing a traveller sees when they plan their trips?

–

Remember: A good question for brainstorming will be narrow and concrete, so that people feel they know how to begin answering it.

Reveal and doubt your boxes

The first step in the creative process entails identifying and doubting one's current boxes and determining which ones require re-evaluation or replacement.

Make a short list of the shared beliefs and assumptions that likely prevail in ClothingCo. Determine which are still relevant and which need to be redefined.

In this fictional scenario, make assumptions that seem reasonable

What boxes currently exist that are still relevant?

1. Our coats must always keep people warm and protect them from bad weather.
2. Customers expect winter wear to last for years as a durable investment.

What boxes currently exist that need to be doubted?

1. Doubting the idea that we can only advertise and sell during freezing months.
2. Doubting the belief that we can only sell to people living in cold regions, ignoring travellers.
3. Doubting the assumption that people buy coats just for survival rather than style or fashion.

Bring new boxes

Prepare for brainstorming by creating new boxes to bring to the session; new boxes will nurture ideation and can dramatically increase the odds of a useful result.

Remember: Defining new boxes requires a mixture of analysis and art. Boxes need to be grounded in fact. Different sectors will call for different inputs.

New box #1

The "Travel & Lifestyle" Box

- We focus on people traveling to cold destinations or commuting across different micro-climates, selling year-round regardless of the local city weather

New box #2

The "Fashion Investment" Box

- We treat our outerwear as a high-style, premium wardrobe essential that customers buy for its aesthetic appeal, not just when they are freezing.

Brainstorm

Choose one of the effective questions you created on slide 5, and a new box from slide 7, and brainstorm potential ideas to address the question

Question

How can we make sure our winter jacket is the first thing a traveler sees when they plan their trips?

New box

The "Fashion Investment" Box

- Partner with travel websites to show jacket ads right on the vacation booking.
- Run digital ads targeting users who are actively searching for flights to cold destinations.
- Place premium display booths inside airport terminals where travellers can order a jacket to their destination.
- Bundle promotions with luxury luggage brands to market the jacket as an essential travel item.

- Collaborate with travel influencers to feature the jacket as a stylish centerpiece in holiday photos.
- Market the jacket as a wrinkle-resistant, easily packable piece for premium carry-on travel.
- Launch advertising campaigns centered around the trendy, high-fashion "airport look."
- Create a high-end trade-in program allowing customers to upgrade their jacket before a big trip.